
3.3 Unit 3, Topic A: UK Political Issues

Focus This topic looks at key policy issues in the UK, particularly those that have affected the outcomes of general elections or stimulated public debate.

What students need to learn: ***Students taking Unit 3, Topic A must learn all areas within the topic.***

Economic Policy

Key concepts	Content explanation
interventionism free market Keynesianism monetarism privatisation economic globalisation	■ A knowledge of the general relationship between the state and the market in economic policy and of debates about the role of economic management. ■ Specific knowledge of policies in relation to economic growth, stability, privatisation, fiscal and monetary policy, employment, inflation, the distribution of income taxation, exchange rates, and trade unions. ■ The impact of economic globalisation and the EU context of economic policy making should also be taken into account.

Social Welfare, Health and Education

Key concepts	Content explanation
welfare state social rights social security individual/social responsibility marketisation quasi-privatisation universalism	■ A general knowledge of the scope and scale of welfare provision and of the changing emphasis of the welfare debate in the UK. ■ A knowledge of party positions and developing public policy related to the benefits or social security system, the education system, the health service and housing provision. (<i>Specific questions on housing alone will not be set.</i>)

Law, Order and Criminal Justice

Key concepts	Content explanation
public order crime punishment	■ A knowledge of party positions and developing public policy related to crime and public order. This includes changing attitudes towards prison policy, young offenders, anti-terrorism and police powers and accountability. ■ Changing attitudes towards the balance between action against crime and against the causes of crime. ■ Students may also be required to assess the efficacy of law and order policies.